

Grade 3 Mathematics — Measurement: Capacity

Measuring capacity in litres

Learning Area Mathematics

Grade 3

Time 30 min

Strand Measurement

Sub-Strand Capacity

🕒 30-Second Summary



What learners will do by end: Learners will measure capacity in litres using containers found at home and school, and appreciate why measuring capacity matters in everyday life.



Total time / prep time: 30 minutes / prep estimate $\leq 20\%$ of lesson time.



The one thing that must not be skipped: Every learner personally pours and measures at least one container's capacity using a 1-litre container, not just watches.



Lesson Details

SCHOOL

DATE

TEACHER'S NAME

LEARNING AREA

Mathematics

TIME

30 minutes

T.S.C NO.

GRADE

3

ROLL

B ___ G ___ Total ___

GENDER

🕒 Lesson Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, the learner should be able to:

- identify the litre as the unit used to measure capacity.
- measure capacity in litres using a 1-litre container.
- appreciate measuring the capacity of containers in litres.

Key Inquiry Question(s)

How can the capacity of a container be measured?

Learning Resources

- Concrete objects/counters: various containers (buckets, bottles, jerry cans, cups)
- Water or sand for measuring
- A 1-litre container (bottle or improvised)
- Chalkboard and chalk

Introduction

~ 2 min

- Teacher opens with a real-life example: "Think about your mother buying milk from a milk vendor at home, or filling a jerry can with water from the tap. How does the vendor or your family know exactly how much milk or water they are getting?" (Learners respond with their own experiences.)
- Assumes $\geq 70\%$ mastery of comparing objects as "more than / less than / same as" from the Mass sub-strand — quick 30-second recall check: "Which of these two bottles do you think holds more water, and how can you tell just by looking?" (Learners point and respond.)



Lesson Development

~ 20 min

1

Teacher models measuring capacity

Fills a 1-litre bottle with water, pours it into a bucket, and thinks aloud: "That's 1 litre. I'll pour again and count." Ask: "How many litres do you think this bucket will hold in total?" Ask: "What happens to the water level each time I add one more litre?"

2

Guided practice

Teacher and class work together with a jug and several 1-litre bottles. Ask: "If I have poured 3 litres so far, how many more until we reach 5 litres?" Learners take turns pouring while the class counts together (builds Communication and Collaboration).

3

Independent task with a self-check

Learners work in pairs with improvised containers (cans, sufurias) and water. Ask: "Which container do you predict holds more, and why?" Each pair estimates the capacity of their container, then measures it using the 1-litre container and records their finding.

Below-target learners: pair with a full-target learner for one-on-one support, re-doing the last worked example together.

Full-target learners: compose a 2-line word problem about capacity for a partner to solve.

Illustration



Learners measure capacity with a 1-litre container



A 1-litre bottle fills a bucket

Conclusion

~ 4 min

- **Self-prediction check:** Show thumbs — green if you could teach this to a friend, yellow if you need one more example, red if you're still stuck.
- **Oral questions to summarise the lesson:** What unit do we use to measure capacity? If a bucket holds 5 litres and I pour out 2 litres, how much is left?

★ Extended Activities

~ 3 min

- **Full-target learners:** at home, find three different containers and estimate their capacity in litres, then measure them with a 1-litre bottle and record the results.
- **Below-target learners:** draw three containers they have at home and guess whether each holds more or less than 1 litre.

Reflection on the Lesson / Self-Remarks

___% of learners were able to measure capacity in litres accurately.

- **If learners underperform: re-do yesterday's counting warm-up with pebbles before starting today's Steps.**
- **If learners exceed expectation early: ask each pair to teach the concept to another pair in their own words.**
- **This plan is a recommendation — adapt based on real-time class response.**

Assessment Rubric

 **Exceeding:** Measures accurately for all containers, explains process clearly.

 **Meeting:** Measures accurately for most containers.

 **Approaching:** Measures with some accuracy, needs prompting.

 **Below:** Needs significant support to measure or estimate.

For coaching questions or feedback, WhatsApp: +254 708 474 116

Sample corpus-grounded draft